



FANTASTIKA

Project Description:

The concept for this project began as an extension of my love of Soviet-era fantasy fiction, a genre colloquially called 'Fantastika'. After searching through Internet Archives, I found a collection of 70s Russian animated and stop-motion children's fairy tales, and I immediately loved the visuals. As I continued to work on the project it slowly morphed into a type of 'dream' design. Especially dreams that you would have, that were neither good nor bad, dreams where it wasn't quite clear if it was a nightmare or not, that would have you thinking about it for the rest of your day.

I also had a lot of inspiration in mind as I made this project because I wanted to invoke a certain feeling. I was thinking of films such as 'The Labyrinth' featuring David Bowie. I also was heavily inspired by 'The Color of Pomegranates' an Armenian film with gorgeous surrealist and avant-garde visuals that is dialogue-less. I also peppered in a reference to Kate Bush's 'Waking Up the Witch' for her album, 'Hounds of Love', as she isn't just a sonic inspiration but also a point of mythology that I often refer to.

The different sound elements within this project, 'Fantastika', include Horse clapping, swamp noises, a Russian waltz (in reference to the video origin). It also includes whispers and gasps because I wanted to express how confusing dreams can be and how often language makes no sense within a dream. Lastly, I used a whispering 'Wake up!' for added dramatic effect to tie into the theme of dreams.

Fantastika is an exploration of the subconscious of dreams, through the use of music, sound effects, foley and dialogue. By invoking the nostalgic elements of childhood, I want the listeners to immerse themselves in dark and fantastical worlds where anything can happen.

